

xstockstrat — CI, Local Stack, and Cloud Infrastructure

A walkthrough of how 15 services build, test, and ship: GitHub Actions for CI, Docker Compose for local development, and DigitalOcean App Platform for dev and prod deploys.

Companion documents

If you want...	Read
The narrative of how features get from idea to production	sdd-flow.pdf
Every lifecycle status and the live backlog snapshot	sdd-lifecycle.pdf
What the platform does end-user-facing + 20-feature active backlog	product-features.pdf

Video Outline (the spine)

Time	Beat	What to show
0:00 – 0:20	What you're looking at. One repo, three runtime contexts: local (compose), dev (DO), prod (DO). Same images, different specs.	Title card. Diagram: repo → CI → registry → DO dev & prod.
0:20 – 0:55	Local stack: docker-compose. TimescaleDB, OTel collector, 13 services, nginx. One <code>docker compose up</code> and the platform is live on <code>localhost</code> .	<code>docker compose up -d</code> , <code>docker compose ps</code> listing healthy services.
0:55 – 1:30	The proto-first build. Stubs are generated from <code>.proto</code> files via a single codegen container. CI's <code>proto-freshness</code> job blocks any drift between committed stubs and what <code>buf generate</code> would produce.	<code>./scripts/buf-gen.sh</code> running, then the CI job catching a stale stub.
1:30 – 2:15	CI: path-filtered, per-service jobs. A <code>paths-filter</code> step detects which services changed; only their lint/test/coverage jobs run. Coverage thresholds enforced per language.	CI YAML showing matrix jobs. GitHub Actions UI showing only changed services running.
2:15 – 2:55	Branch protection + required checks. <code>main</code> and <code>main-dev</code> block direct pushes. CI / Proto lint and breaking check is a required check. A PR cannot merge with a red status.	Settings page showing branch protection rules.
2:55 – 3:40	Deploy on merge: dev (paper) vs prod (live). Push to <code>main-dev</code> → Deploy dev workflow → DOCR image push → DO App Platform update with <code>.do/app.dev.yaml</code> . Push to <code>main</code> → same path with <code>.do/app.yaml</code> .	Workflow run page side-by-side with the two app specs.
3:40 – 4:20	DO App Platform. App spec is checked into the repo. Each service is a separate component with <code>instance_size</code> , <code>instance_count</code> , env vars, and a DOCR image reference. Managed TimescaleDB attached as <code>databases:</code> .	<code>.do/app.yaml</code> showing one service block, the managed DB block.
4:20 – 4:55	Secrets & registry. Secrets injected from GitHub Actions on every deploy. DigitalOcean Container Registry (DOCR) stores images per-SHA + a <code>latest</code> / <code>latest-dev</code> tag. Old images rotated by retention policy.	DOCR repo browser, GitHub secrets settings (blurred values).
4:55 – 5:30	Observability hooks. OTel collector in compose pipes traces locally; production uses OTLP env vars pointing at Grafana Cloud. <code>OTEL_ENABLED=true</code> everywhere.	Grafana Cloud trace view.
5:30 – 6:00	Safety. <code>buf breaking</code> blocks contract regressions. Secret scanning (trufflehog + gitleaks) runs on every PR. <code>db-migrator PRE_DEPLOY</code> job runs migrations before service restarts on every push.	Failing PR with secret scan annotation; successful migration log.
6:00 – 6:30	Outro. All infra config is in the repo. Reproducible from a fresh DO account in under an hour using <code>/digitalocean-setup</code> .	<code>/digitalocean-setup</code> interactive skill running.

The video can be tightened to 3–5 min by collapsing sections 0:55–1:30 and 4:20–4:55 into condensed segments, or extended toward 6:00 for a full infra tour.

Section 1 — Three Runtime Contexts, One Repo

The same code runs in three places:

Context	Compose / orchestrator	Trading mode	Branch	Spec file
Local development	<code>docker-compose.yml</code> (host Docker)	paper (hardcoded)	any	<code>docker-compose.yml</code>
Dev (DigitalOcean)	DO App Platform	paper	<code>main-dev</code>	<code>.do/app.dev.yml</code>
Production (DigitalOcean)	DO App Platform	live	<code>main</code>	<code>.do/app.yml</code>

The trading mode environment variables (`TRADING_MODE` , `ALPACA_PAPER` , `ALPACA_BASE_URL`) are set at the spec level, not in the config service. A live deploy cannot accidentally paper-trade; a dev deploy cannot accidentally live-trade.

Section 2 — Local Stack: `docker-compose.yml`

`docker-compose.yml` is the single source of truth for local development. One command brings up the entire platform on `localhost` :

```
cp .env.example .env          # fill in ALPACA_API_KEY, ALPACA_API_SECRET, JWT_SECRET
./scripts/bootstrap.sh         # checks Docker, generates proto stubs
docker compose up -d          # starts everything
docker compose ps              # all services should be Up / healthy
```

Services running:

Component	Container	Purpose
timescaledb	TimescaleDB	Postgres + time-series hypertables, schema-per-service
db-migrator	golang-migrate	Runs all <code>services/*/migrations/*.up.sql</code> on startup
otel-collector	OTel Collector	Receives OTLP, forwards to Grafana Cloud (or stdout in dev)
xstockstrat-config	Node.js	<code>WatchConfig</code> stream — must come up first
xstockstrat-ledger	Node.js	Append-only event store
xstockstrat-identity	Node.js	JWT issuance and verification
xstockstrat-notify	Node.js	Alert streaming
xstockstrat-marketdata	Go	Alpaca feed, OHLCV storage
xstockstrat-portfolio	Go	Position tracking, P&L
xstockstrat-trading	Go	Order lifecycle
xstockstrat-indicators	Python	Formula sandbox
xstockstrat-ingest	Python	Signal normalization
xstockstrat-analysis	Python	Strategy backtesting
xstockstrat-trader	Next.js	UI :3000
xstockstrat-insights	Next.js	UI :3001
xstockstrat-config-ui	Next.js	UI :3002
nginx	Nginx	Reverse proxy → all three UIs :80

Compose patterns

- **Healthchecks on every service.** A service is only marked `healthy` when its readiness probe passes (`/health` for HTTP services, gRPC health-check for gRPC).
- **depends_on with condition: service_healthy** enforces startup order. The config service comes up first; every other service waits for it.
- **WAIT_FOR entriypoint** in each service: blocks until upstream dependencies are reachable. Survives container restart ordering races.
- **Three env files:** `.env` (secrets, not committed), `.env.local` (structural, committed), `.env.fe.local` (frontend-only, committed). Compose merges all three.

Section 3 — Proto-First Build

Every service consumes generated stubs from `packages/proto/`. The single source of truth lives in `.proto` files; Go, Python, and TypeScript stubs are committed alongside them.

Codegen container

`Dockerfile.codegen` is a single container with `buf` and all three language stub generators pre-installed. Developers do not need Go, Python, or Node installed on the host to regenerate stubs:

```
./scripts/buf-gen.sh
# runs buf inside Dockerfile.codegen container
# writes Go stubs to packages/proto/gen/go/
# writes Python stubs to packages/proto/gen/python/
# writes TypeScript stubs to packages/proto/gen/ts/ (then compiles)
```

Freshness enforcement

A CI job named **"Proto stubs are up to date"** runs `./scripts/buf-gen.sh` and then `git diff --exit-code`. If the committed stubs don't match what regeneration produces, the job fails. This catches:

- A `.proto` edit committed without re-running `buf-gen`
- A `buf` version drift between local and CI
- A generated file edited by hand (forbidden — re-running `buf-gen` always wins)

Breaking change gates

Two `buf` jobs run on every PR:

- `buf lint` — style and structure checks (always required to pass).
- `buf breaking --against main` — fails on any field removal, type change, RPC removal, or other breaking change.

The combined job is named `CI / Proto lint and breaking check` and is the **single required status check** for both `main-dev` and `main` branch protection. No PR can merge with this check red.

Section 4 — CI: Path-Filtered Per-Service Jobs

`.github/workflows/ci.yml` is built around a `paths-filter` step that detects which services changed in the PR. Only those services' lint/test/coverage jobs run. CI on a single-service change finishes in ~5 minutes; a full proto change touching all services takes longer but is still parallelized.

The job matrix

Job	Trigger	Coverage threshold
Detect changed paths	always	—
Proto lint and breaking check	proto OR ci change	hard gate
Proto stubs are up to date	proto OR ci change	hard gate
Go lint and test ({service})	per-Go-service change	≥40%
Python lint ({service})	per-Python-service change	—
Python test and coverage ({service})	per-Python-service change	≥40% (indicators ≥50%)
Node lint ({service})	per-Node-service change	—
Node test and coverage ({service})	per-Node-service change	≥40%
Frontend E2E ({service})	per-Next.js-service change	Playwright pass
secret-scan	always	hard gate (trufflehog + gitleaks)

Per-language tooling

Language	Lint	Test	Coverage
Go 1.25	golangci-lint v2.5.0	go test -race -coverprofile	go tool cover -func ≥40%
Python 3.12	ruff check + ruff format --check	pytest --cov	≥40% (≥50% indicators)
Node.js 22	eslint via pnpm run lint	vitest --coverage	≥40%
Next.js	eslint + Playwright E2E	playwright test	golden-path scenarios

Every Go job sets `GOWORK=off` so per-service builds use the service's own `go.mod`, not the workspace.

Section 5 — Branch Protection and Merge Strategy

Two protected branches:

- **main-dev** — development trunk. All feature branches and `claude/*` branches PR here. Squash and merge.

- **main** — production. Only PRs from `main-dev` and `hotfix/*`. **Merge commit, never squash** (squashing breaks the ancestry; `main-dev` would stay permanently "ahead" of `main`).

Both branches enforce:

Rule	Value
Required status check	CI / Proto lint and breaking check
Require branch up to date before merge	yes (strict)
Required PR reviews	1 approving review
Dismiss stale reviews on new commits	yes
Block direct pushes	yes

Configured via `./scripts/setup-branch-protection.sh` (one-time, uses `gh api`).

Section 6 — Deploy on Merge: Two Pipelines

Push to `main-dev` → Deploy dev (paper)

```
push to main-dev
├─ .github/workflows/deploy-dev.yml
│   ├── buf-push-dev    # publish proto as draft to BSR
│   ├── build-images    # build all 15 service Docker images, push to DOCR
│   └─ deploy           # doctl apps update $DO_DEV_APP_ID --spec .do/app.dev.yaml
│       └─ D0 redeloys components with TRADING_MODE=paper
```

Push to `main` → Deploy prod (live)

```
push to main
├─ .github/workflows/deploy-prod.yml
│   ├── buf-push        # publish proto (final) to BSR
│   ├── build-images    # build all 15 service Docker images, push to DOCR
│   └─ deploy           # doctl apps update $DO_PROD_APP_ID --spec .do/app.yaml
│       └─ D0 redeloys components with TRADING_MODE=live
```

The deploy job is a reusable workflow (`.github/workflows/deploy.yml`) parameterized by: - `DO_APP_ID` — dev vs prod app - `app_spec` — `.do/app.dev.yaml` vs `.do/app.yaml` - `image_tag` — short SHA of the commit being deployed - `BROKER_ACCOUNTS_ENCRYPTION_KEY` — separate dev / prod values pulled from GitHub secrets

Image registry

DigitalOcean Container Registry (DOCR). Every push gets two tags: - The **short SHA** of the commit (`a1b2c3d`) — immutable, used for the exact deploy - A **floating tag** (`latest-dev` or `latest`) — points at the most recent successful build for that environment

Rollback = re-deploy with a previous SHA tag. No image rebuild needed.

Section 7 — DigitalOcean App Platform Specs

`.do/app.yaml` and `.do/app.dev.yaml` are the full deploy specs, checked into the repo. Each is ~530 lines covering 15 service components, a managed Postgres + TimescaleDB cluster, and a `db-migrator` `PRE_DEPLOY` job.

What's in a spec

For each service:

```
- name: xstockstrat-trading
  image:
    registry_type: DOCR
    repository: xstockstrat-trading
    tag: latest
  instance_size_slug: apps-s-1vcpu-1gb
  instance_count: 1
  http_port: 8051
  envs:
    - key: TRADING_MODE
      value: live # paper in app.dev.yaml
    - key: ALPACA_BASE_URL
      value: https://api.alpaca.markets # paper-api.alpaca.markets in dev
    - key: DATABASE_URL
      type: SECRET
      value: ${db.CONNECTION_STRING}
    # ... other env vars
  health_check:
    http_path: /health
```

What's managed

- **Postgres + TimescaleDB cluster** declared in the `databases:` block. DO provisions and connects via `${db.CONNECTION_STRING}` .
- **PRE_DEPLOY job** (`db-migrator`) runs `scripts/db-migrate.sh` against the cluster before any service restarts. `golang-migrate` is idempotent; already-applied migrations are skipped.

- **Internal DNS** — services reach each other via `xstockstrat-<name>.<app>.svc.internal` on prod and bare service names on dev.

Secrets injection

Secrets values are set with `type: SECRET`. They are sourced from GitHub Actions secrets on every deploy via `sed` substitution in the deploy workflow. No secret values live in the repo or git history.

Section 8 — Database Migrations

	Local	DO dev	DO prod
Tool	<code>golang-migrate</code>	<code>golang-migrate</code>	<code>golang-migrate</code>
Trigger	<code>./scripts/db-migrate.sh</code> (manual) or <code>db-migrator</code> compose service	PRE_DEPLOY job on every push to <code>main-dev</code>	PRE_DEPLOY job on every push to <code>main</code>
Source	<code>services/*/migrations/NNN_*.up.sql</code>	same	same
Tracking	<code><schema>.schema_migrations</code>	same	same
Order	trading → portfolio → marketdata → indicators → ingest → analysis → ledger → identity → notify → config	same	same

Convention: each service owns its own schema. Migrations are `NNN_description.up.sql` + `.down.sql`. **Never edit an applied migration** — add a new numbered one instead. CI's `db-migrator` runs idempotently on every deploy.

Section 9 — Observability

OpenTelemetry SDK in every service (Go, Python, Node.js) exports OTLP. Toggle: `OTEL_ENABLED=true`.

Local

`docker-compose.yml` runs an `otel-collector` container. The collector receives OTLP from all services and (optionally) forwards to Grafana Cloud if `OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_HEADERS` is set, otherwise just logs to stdout.

Production

Services emit OTLP directly to Grafana Cloud:

```
- key: OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_ENDPOINT
  value: https://otlp-gateway-prod-<region>.grafana.net/otlp
- key: OTEL_EXPORTER_OTLP_HEADERS
  type: SECRET
  value: Authorization=Basic ...
```

OTel init errors **never** block service startup. If the collector is down, the service runs without telemetry — it does not crash-loop.

Trace propagation

`x-trace-id` is propagated through every gRPC and Connect-RPC call via a service-specific interceptor:

- Go: `internal/telemetry/` package, unary + stream interceptors
- Python: per-method header propagation
- Node.js: `AsyncLocalStorage` carries the trace ID through async chains

Section 10 — Secret Hygiene

Secret scanning runs on **every PR** as part of CI:

- **trufflehog** — pattern-based scan across the full commit history
- **gitleaks** — second-source scanner with custom rules in `.gitleaks.toml`

Both must pass. Public-repo audit script `scripts/security-audit.sh` runs the same checks locally before any sensitive change.

Secret namespacing in config: - `secret.*` keys are never logged - `secret.*` keys are never shipped to telemetry - `secret.*` keys are read-only via the config UI (admins only)

GitHub Actions secrets injected at deploy time: - `DIGITALOCEAN_ACCESS_TOKEN` (deploy auth) - `DO_REGISTRY_NAME` (image push target) - `DO_DEV_APP_ID` / `DO_PROD_APP_ID` - `DEV_BROKER_ACCOUNTS_ENCRYPTION_KEY` / `PROD_BROKER_ACCOUNTS_ENCRYPTION_KEY` - `BUF_TOKEN` (BSR proto publishing)

None of these values are in the repo. The deploy workflow reads them from the GitHub secrets API at run time.

Section 11 — First-Time Setup Skill

The whole DO infrastructure can be bootstrapped from a fresh account using the `/digitalocean-setup` skill (interactive, 9 numbered steps):

1. `doctl` auth and project setup
2. DOCR (Container Registry) creation
3. Managed PostgreSQL + TimescaleDB cluster
4. Dev App Platform app from `.do/app.dev.yaml`
- 4.5. DOCR-to-app linkage
5. Prod App Platform app from `.do/app.yaml`
6. Secrets wiring (GitHub Actions → DO)
7. GitHub Actions workflow validation
8. First deployment trigger
9. Smoke test

Each step is idempotent — re-running the skill on a partially-configured account picks up where the last run stopped. The skill prompts before any destructive action.

Section 12 — Reproducibility Checklist

What you need to recreate this infrastructure from scratch:

- [] A DigitalOcean account with billing enabled
- [] A Grafana Cloud account (free tier works) — for OTel ingestion
- [] An Alpaca account (paper for dev, live for prod) — for trading APIs
- [] A BSR account — for proto publishing (optional; CI can skip BSR push)
- [] A GitHub repo with Actions secrets configured (script + values via `/digitalocean-setup`)
- [] `gh`, `doctl`, and `docker` CLIs installed locally for the first-time setup

End-to-end time from empty DO account to live dev deploy: **~45 minutes** with `/digitalocean-setup`.

Outro

All infrastructure config — CI workflows, compose file, DO specs, migrations, secret-scanning rules — is checked into this repo. Nothing depends on a private wiki or a `~/.config` file. Pull the repo, run the setup skills, and you have the same dev + prod environment.

The infrastructure itself is also a feature in the backlog. `038-ci-docker-registry-deploy` (launched) is what introduced the DOCR + GitHub Actions build pipeline described above. `033-phase7-observability`

(draft) will activate the OTel SDK already stubbed into every service. See [product-features.pdf](#) § "What's Next" or browse [docs/roadmap/features/](#) directly.

Repository: github.com/davcs86/xstockstrat **Setup runbooks:** [docs/setup/](#) **CI overview:** [docs/patterns/ci-overview.md](#) **Docker patterns:** [docs/patterns/docker-build.md](#)